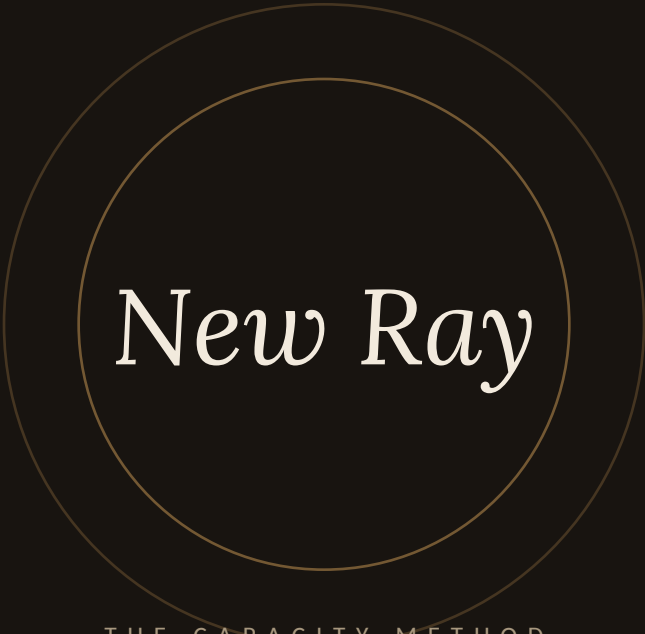




*New Ray*

THE CAPACITY METHOD

PART FOUR

# *Yellow Day Protocol*

---

How to stay steady when you have some energy — but not  
unlimited energy.

*Created by Vanessa Parkin, RN*

## What a Yellow Day actually is

A Yellow Day is the most common capacity state for many adults. You're not in survival mode, but you're not at full capacity either. You have enough energy to function and move life forward — what you don't have is unlimited energy.

The biggest mistake people make on Yellow Days is treating them like Green Days — saying yes to everything, cleaning the whole house, starting new projects. This often creates tomorrow's Red Day.

You can do things. You just cannot do everything.

## The Yellow Day goal

Maintain stability while making reasonable progress. Not optimization. Not maximum productivity. **Progress without depletion.**

The Yellow Day rule

*“Protect tomorrow while handling today. Can I still do this if I feel the same tomorrow?”*

## The priority system

|                  |                                                                                               |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Essential</b> | Must happen: work responsibilities, childcare, meals, appointments, basic home maintenance.   |
| <b>Important</b> | Helpful but flexible: exercise, errands, meal prep, admin, personal projects.                 |
| <b>Optional</b>  | Can wait: deep cleaning, major organizing, perfectionist projects, catching up on everything. |

Complete essentials first. Choose one or two important tasks. Let optional tasks remain optional.

## The routine framework

Yellow Days thrive on simple anchors — not strict schedules.

› **Morning:** water, protein, get dressed, identify your top priority.

- › **Midday:** eat, then a capacity check-in — “What do I have left?” Adjust.
- › **Evening:** a basic reset (dishes, laundry, prep tomorrow if helpful) — then stop.

## The Yellow Day trap

A little extra energy does not mean unlimited energy. A Yellow Day whispers, “Maybe I can do it all today.” Respectfully: no. Protect your progress.

### The self-talk shift

|                   |                                                                         |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Instead of</b> | “I should be doing more.” → “I am using my capacity wisely.”            |
| <b>Instead of</b> | “I need to catch up.” → “I need to stay sustainable.”                   |
| <b>Instead of</b> | “Why am I not doing more?” → “What is realistic for my capacity today?” |

## Movement, food & boundaries

**Movement:** keep it supportive, not exhausting — a 10–20 minute walk, gentle strength, stretching, or playing outside with your kids.

**Food:** a chance to rebuild gently — protein at meals, consistent hydration, fruit and veg when possible. Simple over perfect.

**Boundaries:** before you say yes, ask — *Do I have energy for this, or am I borrowing it from tomorrow?* That one question prevents many Red Days.

## You handled a Yellow Day well if...

|                          |                                    |
|--------------------------|------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> | You completed your essentials      |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | You maintained basic self-care     |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | You honored your limits            |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | You made progress without crashing |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | You protected tomorrow’s capacity  |

FROM VANESSA

Most of life is not lived on Green Days. Most of life happens in the middle.

For a long time I treated every decent day like a chance to catch up — and kept creating more Red Days. Everything changed when I realized Yellow Days were for stabilizing, not sprinting.

The goal is not to maximize every day. The goal is to create a life you can realistically sustain.